

CASE ID: 202411710002

**EPISODE NAME: China bans export of gallium, germanium, antimony**

2024/11/28 - 2025/11/09

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Negotiated Settlement following sanctions imposition (10)

### **Summary:**

On 2024/11/28, China warned the US that it would retaliate if the US imposed additional semiconductor export control measures. After the Biden Administration imposed the restrictions on 2024/12/03, China banned the export of gallium, germanium, antimony to the US on 2024/12/03. The episode ended on 2025/11/09 when China suspended the all-out ban on these metals during trade negotiations with the Trump Administration, although they may be re-imposed on 2026/11/27 if a permanent agreement is not reached.

### **Narrative:**

On 2024/11/28, China warned the United States that it would retaliate if the Biden Administration proceeded with adding an additional 200 Chinese companies to the semiconductor export control list.<sup>1</sup> The threat was levied by the Chinese ministry of Commerce when spokesperson He Yadong said Beijing would “take necessary actions” if the US “escalated” export control measures.<sup>2</sup>

After Washington imposed the restrictions on 2024/12/02, China responded by banning the export of gallium, germanium, antimony to the US on 2024/12/03.<sup>3</sup> China framed the decision as retaliation for the US’s abuses of export controls.<sup>5</sup> Analysis suggested that the restrictions would impose significant costs on the US defense industry.<sup>6</sup>

This episode is part of an ongoing campaign of semiconductor related export controls that began with the US export controls on 2022/10/07.<sup>7</sup>

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<sup>1</sup> “China Warns of 'Necessary Actions' If US Escalates Chip Curbs.” *Reuters*, 28 Nov. 2024.

<https://www.reuters.com/markets/china-warns-necessary-actions-if-us-escalates-chip-curbs-2024-11-28/>

<sup>2</sup> *Ibid.*

<sup>3</sup> “US targets China's chip industry with new restrictions.” *Reuters*, 2 Dec. 2024.

<https://www.reuters.com/technology/us-targets-chinas-chip-industry-with-new-restrictions-2024-12-02/>

<sup>4</sup> Kurtenbach, Elaine. “China Bans Exports to US of Gallium, Germanium, Antimony in Response to Chip Sanctions.” *AP News*, 3 Dec. 2024,

<apnews.com/article/china-us-tech-semiconductor-chip-gallium-6b4216551e200fb719caa6a6cc67e2a4>.

<sup>5</sup> *Ibid.*

<sup>6</sup> Baskaran, Gracelin and Meredith Schwartz. “China Imposes Its Most Stringent Critical Minerals Export Restrictions Yet Amidst Escalating U.S.-China Tech War.” *Center for Strategic and International Studies*, 4 Dec. 2024. <https://www.csis.org/analysis/china-imposes-its-most-stringent-critical-minerals-export-restrictions-yet-amidst>

<sup>7</sup> Swanson, Ana. “Biden Administration Clamps Down on China’s Access to Chip Technology.” *New York Times*, 7 Oct. 2022. <https://www.nytimes.com/2022/10/07/business/economy/biden-chip-technology.html>

The episode ended on 2025/11/09, after China agreed to suspend the ban until 2025/11/27 as part of a trade deal negotiated with US president Donald Trump.<sup>8</sup>

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<sup>8</sup> “China suspends ban on exports of certain metals used in chip and electronics manufacturing to the U.S.” *CNBC*, 9 Nov. 2025,  
<https://www.cnbc.com/2025/11/09/china-suspends-ban-on-exports-of-gallium-germanium-antimony-to-us.html>